Brad Spendlove - Curriculum Vitae

George Bradley Spendlove • bspendlove@randolph.edu • (210) 823-7968

Education

Brigham Young University - Provo, UT

PhD in Computer Science **August 2023**
Dissertation: Semantically Structured Creative Computer Systems & Automated Evaluation of Creative Artifacts

Master of Science in Computer Science **April 2019**
Thesis: Security Analysis and Recommendations for CONIKS as a PKI Solution for Mobile Apps

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science **April 2013**

Academic Experience

Assistant Professor of Computer Science: 2023–Current
Randolph College - Lynchburg, VA

Teaching:

- Intro to Programming I & II
- Data Structures
- Algorithms
- Operating Systems
- Artificial Intelligence
- Computer Graphics
- Computer Networks
- Intro to Cybersecurity

Undergraduate Advising:

- Senior Seminar advisees for Computer Science capstone papers & presentations
- Over two dozen total academic advisees, including first-year students

Instructor, Summer Residential Governor's School: Summer 2024, 2025, 2026
Lynchburg University

Student Instructor, CS 235 Data Structures: Spring 2020
Supervisor: Dr. Mark Clement, BYU Computer Science Department

Research Experience

Voting Member:
Association for Computational Creativity (ACC) 2024–Current

Program Committee Member:
International Conference on Computational Creativity (ICCC) 2022–2026
Portuguese Conference on Artificial Intelligence (EPIA), Thematic Track on AI and Creativity 2023–2025

Publication Chair & Editor:
International Conference on Computational Creativity (ICCC) 2025

Faculty Mentor:
Randolph College Summer Research Program 2024–2026

Workshop Co-Organizer:
ICCC 2024 Hands-On Codenames Workshop - Jönköping, Sweden

- Co-developed and hosted an interactive workshop continuing my PhD research on creative AI gameplay.

Research Assistant with BYU Machine Intelligence and Discovery Lab: Dec 2018–Aug 2023
Advisor: Dr. Dan Ventura, BYU Computer Science Department

- Developed creative computer systems for writing short stories and playing language games.
- Prepared research papers on computational creativity systems and theory.

Research Intern at MIT Lincoln Laboratory: May–July 2018
Mentor: Dr. Scott Ruoti, formerly MITLL, now University of Tennessee

- Designed and implemented an extensible simulation for comparing various blockchain technologies.

Research Assistant with BYU Internet Security Research Lab: Jan 2017–Dec 2018
Advisor: Dr. Kent Seamons, BYU Computer Science Department

- Prepared my thesis and lab research papers on key management and usable security.
- Coordinated a 60-participant user study comparing email encryption programs.

Publications

Spendlove, B. and Kline, D. (Forthcoming). An Initial Design for Generative Game Mechanics via LLM Function Emulation. In *Proceedings of the 17th International Conference on Computational Creativity*.

Morain, R., Spendlove, B. and Ventura, D. 2025. A Development and Teaching Framework for Codenames. In *Proceedings of the 16th International Conference on Computational Creativity*, 239-247.

Spendlove, B. and Ventura, D. 2023. Constraints as Catalysts: A (De) Construction of Codenames as a Creative Task. In *Proceedings of the 14th International Conference on Computational Creativity*, 337-341.

Spendlove, B. and Brown, D. 2023. What makes gameplay creative. In *Proceedings of the 14th International Conference on Computational Creativity*, 98-101.

Spendlove, B. and Ventura, D. 2022. Competitive Language Games as Creative Tasks with Well-Defined Goals. In *Proceedings of the 13th International Conference on Computational Creativity*, 291–299.

Spendlove, B. and Ventura, D. 2020. Humans in the Black Box: A New Paradigm for Evaluating the Design of Creative Systems. In *Proceedings of the 11th International Conference on Computational Creativity*, 311–318.

Spendlove, B. and Ventura, D. 2020. Creating Six-word Stories via Inferred Linguistic and Semantic Formats. In *Proceedings of the 11th International Conference on Computational Creativity*, 123–130.

Spendlove, B. and Ventura, D. 2019. Modeling Knowledge, Expression, and Aesthetics via Sensory Grounding. In *Proceedings of the 10th International Conference on Computational Creativity*, 326–330.

Spendlove, B., Zabriskie, N., and Ventura, D. 2018. An HBPL-based Approach to the Creation of Six-word Stories. In *Proceedings of the 9th International Conference on Computational Creativity*, 161–168.

Ruoti, S., Andersen, J., Dickinson, L., Heidbrink, S., Monson, T., O'neill, M., Reese, K., Spendlove, B., Vaziripour, E., Wu, J., Zappala, D. and Seamons, K. 2019. A Usability Study of Four Secure Email Tools Using Paired Participants. In *ACM Transactions on Privacy and Security (TOPS)*, 22(2), 13.

Presentations & Awards

Speaker, Randolph College Summer Research Program Seminar: May 2024
"Computational Creativity"

Panelist, AI Panel – Opportunities and Challenges: March 2024
Randolph College SciFest 2024

Speaker, BYU CS Grad Seminar: Sept 2022
"Competitive Language Games as Creative Tasks with Well-Defined Goals"

Recipient, 2022 Artificial Intelligence Journal Student Scholarship: June 2022
Awarded by the 13th International Conference on Computational Creativity

Participant, Doctoral Consortia: July 2018 & July 2019
9th & 10th International Conferences on Computational Creativity

Professional Experience

Software Developer for PIC Business Systems: Dec 2014–June 2016

- Designed and developed features for a large-scale PHP application, working directly with customers.

Software Development Engineer for Microsoft Corp.: Sept 2013–Sept 2014

- Developed and tested various features for Windows Azure Tools for Visual Studio, both UI and backend.

Software Development Engineer Intern for Microsoft Corp.: Summer 2013

- Designed and prototyped new feature for Visual Studio in C# and Javascript.